



# TIPS & TRICKS

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

## TIPS

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## EMAIL

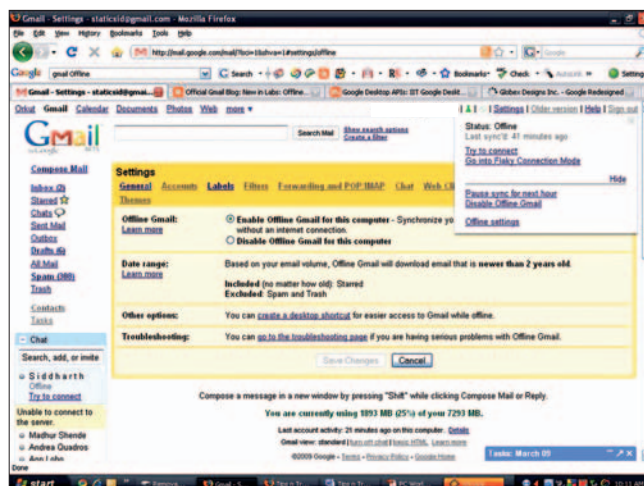
Gmail has by now grown to be ubiquitous. Almost all of us have a Gmail account and in most cases, it's our primary email address. The main reason why we've come to prefer Gmail so much is innovation. This innovation comes by way of experiments that Gmail conducts in its Google Labs. Gmail deploys and tests most of its ideas in its labs, before a proper mainstream release. Many of these ideas come as suggestions from Gmail users, and many come from people at Google. They're aimed at improving functionality and overall user experience and some of them are certainly worth checking out. To enable any labs feature, click on Settings and go to the Labs tab. Gmail labs currently lists some 30-odd lab features, from which we have here selected the ones we like the most. To activate any of them, click the 'enable' radio button for a particular feature and click 'save changes'. Labs works best with keyboard shortcuts, so we recommend you switch these on. To switch on keyboard shortcuts go to the General settings tab and activate this feature.

### Create a Gmail back up (Offline)

Gmail lists this feature in its labs as the 'Offline' mode. According to the company, it will allow you to work in the familiar browser-based Gmail environment, even when you are offline. It's an attempt by Google to come as close to Microsoft Outlook as



Enable or disable features from the Labs tab under Settings



Choosing your Offline settings

possible. Nevertheless, email requires you to be connected at least at some point. So what use is the feature then? Although it may come in handy to compose a few drafts in those rare instances of internet failure, we found an alternate use. The feature can be used to back up your entire Gmail account! So if for some reason you loose access to your account, or if one day Gmail decides it's not going to be so generous with storage space and is going to delete your older mails, you already have a backup ready. Also, this backup lies in the safety of your personal hardrive.

To back up your account, enable the feature from Labs. Once enabled, an "Offline 0.1" link will appear at the top-right corner of your Gmail interface. Click on it and your browser will prompt you to install the Google Gears add-on (currently not supported in Opera). If you are using Chrome as your browser, Gears is installed by default. Click install and let Gears install on your computer. You will need to restart your browser once Gears has finished the download and installation. On restarting your browser, a Gears security warning will seek

your permission to store information on your computer. Check the box and click to allow this. It will now create shortcuts on the desktop or start menu as per your preference and begin downloading all your mail onto your system. This could take a while, since most of us have accumulated thousands of emails over the years. However, based on your email volume, Offline Gmail will not download mail that's older than two years, and obviously Spam and Trash will also be avoided. Who wants that anyway? There is also the new Flaky Connection Mode which

is a nice feature when you're on an unreliable or slow connection. It is somewhere in between using your local cache of downloaded information and a fully fledged network connection. It uses the local cache as if you were disconnected, but still synchronises your mail with the server in the background. To go into, or leave, Flaky Mode, simply click on the offline icon in the top-right corner. We encountered several glitches where Gmail restricted access to some functions even when Flaky mode was off. Repeatedly clicking "Leave Flaky Mode" didn't seem to help either.

### Quote only selected text

One of the most irritating things while sending a reply is having to quote the sender's entire text. Many times, we send a reply only in the context of a few sentences of a particular mail. Well, now with Gmail's